

10 June 2003

Dear Jen,

Today was a very, very hot day. The heat was stifling by ten in the morning and has not let up all day. To add to my discomfort, the electricity was not working in our TOC so we could not power our weak-ass Iraqi air-conditioner or our ceiling fans. I just sat here sweating.

To make things even better, we received an intelligence report from an Iraqi citizen this morning informing us that paramilitary elements in our area were planning an attack on us this evening. Apparently they would use a red-star cluster as a trigger for the attack and would then bomb US command posts or patrols with mortar rounds and hand grenades. All this has led to a very busy day in the TOC. Either the Colonel or the XO has been in the TOC all day and I have not been able to relax for even a minute.

The TOC was a busy place this afternoon as the commanders developed a course of action in response to this threat. Right now, we have several helicopters observing our area of operations, as well as a good number of observation points established. We also increased our presence along the major highways and are conducting thorough traffic stops, searching almost every vehicle.

So far we have observed a number of flares and star clusters, but they have all turned out to be the usual Baghdad riff-raff celebratory fire and none have signaled the beginning of an assault. One of our scouts was in a short firefight with an unknown person. When they returned fire, however, their attacker disappeared. Other than that, nothing has happened.

Captain Nutt is studying for the GRE, and we have been learning the vocabulary words together. I now know words like aver; to affirm, and loquacious; talkative. Impressive, eh? Regardless, it has been a very busy day with surprisingly little to report.

I worked out this morning and am very sore. I did deadlifts, pull ups, hyperextensions, and sit ups. Holy cow, I am hurting. Additionally, Major Cribb and Colonel Ingram will be leaving us in the next few weeks to take new assignments back at home. Must be nice. They will be coming home and we will be staying here. I don't like that at all, but hopefully we will at least get some news regarding redeployment.

I love you and Mason and miss you both. I can't wait to come home.

Love,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Christian".

Christian